Wayne Kim

Interaction Designer

Los Angeles, CA · Open to relocating to San Francisco

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I design physical-digital touchpoints (light, sound, sensors, and small screens), prototype them with Arduino, CAD, and Figma, and test them with people. Seven years in design research at Designit and startups backed by a16z, YC, and SoftBank, then a Master's in Interaction Design at CIID.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Toilet Paper Elevator | sensor and e-ink display, solo — 2026

- An e-ink display that turns a home's toilet paper use into a climb past landmarks, counted by a Hall effect sensor.
- Modeled the enclosure in Fusion 360; redesigned the wire and sensor holder 5 times so the roll stays easy to change.

room_tone | ambient light, motion, and sound, solo — 2026

- A Python state machine notices 90 minutes of work, then layers in light, motion, and music via smart plugs and Spotify.

Living.fm | AI device, CIID team — 2025

- A small speaker and camera system with an AI voice. I trained the vision model and coded when it speaks.
- Built a live internal testing tool that showed what the camera saw next to what it would say.

Linee | wall timekeeper, CIID team — 2025

- Press-to-mark wooden blocks; a moving needle knocks each planned hour. I wrote the stepper motor code.

EXPERIENCE

Independent | Interaction Designer — Sept 2025 - Present

- Building calm tech for the home, plus two NDA client projects with CIID (medical technology, AI translation).

Glorify | Senior Design Researcher — Feb 2023 - Feb 2024

- Ran a 2-week prototype diary study with 82 people in their real small groups. 65% were still active at week two.
- Turned the findings into three design principles with product and engineering; Glorify Groups launched in the mobile app and reached 1.8M+ users by 2025.
- Built the research practice and grew the team from one researcher to three.

Designit | Design Researcher — Aug 2021 - Jan 2023

- Led usability testing and mixed-methods research for Fortune 500 clients; facilitated a 3-day, 60-person workshop.

Independent | Designer and Researcher | Y Combinator companies, San Francisco — Jun 2020 - Aug 2021

RaiseMe | UX Strategist | San Francisco, rebuilt the college data portal — Dec 2017 - Jun 2020

Reed College | Assistant Dean | grew a new program 8x — Jan 2015 - Nov 2017

EDUCATION

Copenhagen Institute of Interaction Design (CIID) | Master's in Interaction Design — Sept 2024 - Aug 2025

LACI | Product Design Fellowship | SolidWorks (CSWA prep), OSHA 10 — Oct 2026 - Dec 2026

Colby College | B.A. in Sociology — Sept 2010 - May 2014

SKILLS

Interaction design	physical-digital touchpoints, physical input, light and audio cues, small and screenless displays
Prototyping	Arduino, ESP32, sensors, LEDs, motors, e-ink, 3D printing, laser cutting, Wizard-of-Oz
Research	usability testing, prototype diary studies, interviews, synthesis
Tools	Figma, Fusion 360, SolidWorks, Python, Processing, TouchDesigner, Cursor, Claude Code